Air coolers

Air coolers have fewer components than liquid coolers and thus, are easy to care for. Here's the most that you can do for your air-cooler.

Thermal paste

Depending upon the materials used in the thermal paste, it can harden over time and lose thermal conductivity. Often, if the paste hardens, then it can lose contact with the heatsink or the CPU if the cooler sags a little over time. So always keep an eye out on your CPU temperature. You can find many software that'll do this, CPU-Z, RealTemp, CCleaner are commonly used free software.

Cracked thermal paste

Mounting

Since the coolers have massive 120/140 mm fans attached to them, the vibration caused by the fans can permeate towards the mounting mechanism and over time, the screws can come loose. This is one of the reasons why coolers develop a sag over time, the other being deformation caused by mechanical stress. When this happens, the cooler may lose contact with the CPU. So check your mounting mechanism if you've noticed a sudden sharp rise in temperatures.

Fan

Fans fall victim to dust clogs. The fan blades have the most visible amount of dust clogging, however, you should also pay attention to the bearing of